The Sādhana of Two-Armed Hevajra

Dvibhujahevajrasādhana · Toh 1276 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་བ་རྡོ་རྗེ་ཕྱེད་ཀྱ་གཉིས་པའ་སིདྡྷ་པའ་ཐབས

The Sādhana of Two-Armed Hevajra, known in Sanskrit as Dvibhujahevajrasādhana and in Tibetan as Gyepa Dorjé Chak Nyipé Druppé Tap, is a short tantric meditation manual catalogued as Toh 1276 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the commentaries and practice texts on the tantras. Written largely in verse, it guides the practitioner through choosing a suitable place, going for refuge and cultivating the four immeasurables, dissolving ordinary appearance into emptiness, and generating the two-armed Hevajra in union with Nairātmyā, surrounded by the eight goddesses Gaurī, Caurī and the rest, together with the symbolism of the deity's ornaments and implements. It closes with the empowerment by the five Tathāgatas, the deity's mantra, the concluding offerings and dedication, and a colophon stating that it was condensed from the Hevajra Tantra and translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Sumatiśrībhadra and the monk Shākya Ö.

In the language of India: dvibhujahevajrasādhanaṃ. In the language of Tibet: The Sādhana of Two-Armed Hevajra.

Homage to the glorious Vajra Heruka.

Abiding in the syllables evaṃ,
Lord of the four joys and the rest,
Free from beginning, middle and end:
To that Vajradhara I pay homage.

With reverence for the gurus, for the Buddha,
For the Dharma and the Saṅgha,
And having bowed to vajra practitioners elder and younger,
I shall explain the sādhana of Hevajra.

First, the practice. One should look for a good place of the kind that is taught, where the mantra practitioner attains accomplishments and the mind becomes one-pointed: a solitary tree, a charnel ground, a shrine of the mātṛkās, likewise at night, the edge of a village secluded from people, or a place praised as a hermitage.

Imagine raṃ in one's own heart, and on the sun disk that arises from it generate hūṃ as well. Embraced at the neck with passion by Ḍombinī, the one

who embodies method and wisdom is born from the vajra. To that compassionate lord, the eight goddesses, adorned with every ornament, make offerings: Gaurī holding the deer-marked moon, Caurī holding the vessel of the sun, Vetālī holding water, Ghasmarī holding medicine, Pukkasī holding a vajra in her hand, Śavarī holding the elixir, and Caṇḍālī holding a ḍamaru, while Ḍombinī herself makes offering. One should behold in the sky these goddesses making offerings to the principal deity.

Then:
I go for refuge to the Three Jewels.
I confess all wrongdoing.
I rejoice in the virtue of beings.
I take buddha-awakening to heart.

First one should cultivate loving-kindness;
Second one should cultivate compassion;
Third, having cultivated joy,
Last of all comes equanimity.

Further, by focusing on the mind as emptiness, one should abandon ordinary pride: oṃ śūnyatājñānavajrasvabhāva ātmako'haṃ.

First, imagine a sun arising from raṃ.
Well placed in the center of the sun,
Imagine a crossed vajra arising from hūṃ.
From that vajra, a fence,
And meditate that it is covered by a vajra tent.
Having meditated on the bhaga in the expanse of space,
What is to be meditated within it is this:
First one should imagine a corpse;
It is called the dharmadhātu, selflessness.
The yogin abiding upon it
Should meditate as Heruka.
From āli the moon, from kāli the sun;
Upon them, visualize the seed hūṃ.
From hūṃ one should imagine a vajra,
And in the hub of the vajra, hūṃ again:
Imagine that very hūṃ residing there.
Mirror-like wisdom is the moon;
The seven-horsed sun has the wisdom of equality;

Discerning is the hand emblems and seeds, each one;
Gathering all into one is diligent action;
The perfect body is pure dharmatā.
These five aspects of full awakening
The wise are taught to meditate in sequence.
Arising wholly from the body of a sentient being,
One should meditate on the lord of the maṇḍala,
With faces and hand emblems as taught,
Possessed of light like crystal.
In joy the two enter union:
He is joined with Nairātmyā.
Through the union of churner and churned,
Gaurī and the others are to be emanated.

They are emanated from the seeds gaṃ caṃ baṃ ghaṃ paṃ saṃ laṃ ḍaṃ.

In Indra's quarter, Gaurī; in Yama's, Caurī.
In the quarter of Water, Vetālī;
In Kubera's quarter, Ghasmarī;
Pukkasī is held to be in Īśāna's.
In the quarter of Fire, Śavarī;
Caṇḍālī dwells in Nairṛti's;
In the quarter of Wind, Ḍombī is held to be.
Gaurī becomes black in color;
Caurī has the color of madder;
Vetālī has the color of the chief lady;
Ghasmarī is like the margata emerald;
Pukkasī has the color of indranī sapphire;
Śavarī is like crystal;
Caṇḍālī is blue like the sky;
Ḍombinī is of many colors.

Blazing with light upon a corpse,
Two-armed, his hair bound upward,
Red-eyed, and with a single face,
He is adorned with the five mudrās.
In one hand he holds a kapāla;
In his right hand is a curved knife;
The khaṭvāṅga is in his left;

His waist is covered with a tiger skin.

Then, through the vajra's great passion,
He melts together with his consort.
Then with various songs and offerings
The goddesses exhort him:

"With your mind of compassion, O lord, arise!
Protect me, Pukkasī, completely.
Abandon the samādhi of emptiness
And unite with me in longing for great bliss."

"If you do not stay, I shall die;
So abandon the nature of emptiness,
And to bring Śavarī's fruit to fulfillment,
Hevajra, arise!"

"When desire weighs upon the heart of the world,
Lord, why do you remain in emptiness?
If you do not stay, I am lost in every direction;
So I, Caṇḍālī, make this plea."

"I long for your heart:
Arise like an illusion!
Lord of beings, by your word I know well:
Do not cut off the stream of compassion!"

First is emptiness, awakening;
Second is the gathering of the seed;
Third is the completion of the form;
With the fourth, the seed is set in place.
From the vajra hūṃ, as the great Vajra,
The melted form rises up again.
For the welfare of beings, through light rays
One's own body is emanated,
Pervading the whole sphere of the sky,
And each assembly gathers back again.

The yogin becomes the very nature of aversion,
His color blue and slightly red,
His tawny hair bound upward,

Adorned with the ornaments of the five mudrās.
The wheel, the earrings, the necklace,
The bracelets and the girdle
Are the purity of the five buddhas,
Renowned as the five mudrās.
Sixteen years old in form, he gazes wrathfully.
His left hand is marked with a vajra skull cup,
The khaṭvāṅga is also at the left,
A blazing vajra in the right;
He is the very nature of the roaring hūṃ.
Encircled by the eight goddesses,
The protector sports within the charnel ground.

"Glorious" is nondual wisdom;
he is the emptiness of cause and the rest;
ru is freedom from arrangement;
ka is not abiding anywhere.
Since he is born from the dharmadhātu,
One meditates on the very nature of dharmatā: oṃ dharmadhātusvabhāva ātmako'haṃ.

The eye is the Vajra Lady of Delusion;
The ear, the Vajra Lady of Aversion;
The nose, the Vajra Lady of Avarice;
The tongue, the Vajra Lady of Attachment;
Touch, the Vajra Lady of Envy.
The yoginī Nairātmyā is the mind;
Bhūcarī is the body vajra;
Khecarī is the speech vajra.
Because mind dwells at the center,
Nairātmyā is born at the center.

From one's own heart the seed arises,
Possessed of black light rays.
With rays shaped like hooks,
The buddhas dwelling in the three realms
Are summoned together with the eight consorts;
Having worshiped them properly, one makes the request,
With oṃ abhiṣiñcatu maṃ sarvatathāgata.

The five Tathāgatas, having the bodily appearance of Heruka,
Themselves embodying the five Tathāgatas,
With vases filled with the five nectars
Confer the empowerment. Amid the sound of beaten drums a rain of flowers and a rain of saffron falls, Compassion and the others offer praise, and Locanā and the others sing songs. Through this empowerment the lord of one's own family comes to sit upon one's head.

The form of the wheel is Akṣobhya;
The earrings are the nature of Amitābha;
The necklace is the nature of Ratnasambhava;
The bracelets are held to be Vairocana;
On the girdle sits Amoghasiddhi.
The khaṭvāṅga is the nature of wisdom.
The lotus vessel is the severing of concepts
Of saṃsāra and nirvāṇa.
As the cause of liberation,
He drinks the blood of the four māras.
The red eyes are compassion;
The black limbs are a mind of loving-kindness;
The skin is the seven limbs of awakening;
The bone ornaments are the Four Truths.
Wrath is for the wicked who are to be tamed.
Blood is shown as Śavarī;
Semen is renowned as Caṇḍālī;
Fat and marrow are Ḍombinī.
To cut off the six faults, the māras and the rest,
He abides holding a curved knife.
The skull cup is the essence of emptiness;
Know everything as method.
Blessed at the three junctures of the day,
One should abide in the body of the deity.
When performing activities, the yogin
Should keep this yoga in mind.
Not even for an instant should the wise practitioner
Who seeks accomplishment, striving with diligence,
Dwell in any other mind,
A mind possessed of wicked ignorance.

If the yogin meditates for six months,
There is no doubt here: he will attain accomplishment.
Have no hesitation about this;
The miraculous power of the buddhas is inconceivable.
However many limbs there are,
And all that has been described above,
So many are the mantras and mudrās,
Abiding in the state of the glorious Heru.
Its mantra is this: oṃ trailokyākṣepa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Having invited them for the purpose of requesting them to depart, one should worship them properly, fully dedicate the merit, and ask their forbearance. This is the guru's instruction for rising after having visualized Heruka.

Whoever always tastes the curd of supreme wisdom,
The nectar of the holy guru's instruction,
Will by that attain buddhahood.

By gathering in sequence what is found
In what was taught in the Hevajra Tantra,
And making clear the sādhana of Hevajra,
Whatever immeasurable merit I have gathered,
By it may beings with many ill omens and faults,
Their minds bewildered by suffering,
All without exception, become fit vessels
For the great maṇḍala of the Lord of Sages, the glorious king.

The Sādhana of Hevajra Condensed from the Teachings is complete. It was translated by the Indian preceptor Sumatiśrībhadra and the monk Shākya Ö.

Translator's Notes

• Gaurī's emblem is literally "the deer-marked one," a standard epithet of the moon, which pairs with Caurī's sun. Śavarī's emblem ro is taken as "elixir" (rasa) rather than "corpse." The line on the sun reads literally "the seventh," taken as the epithet "seven-horsed." In the line placing Caurī the Tibetan reads sku, "body," where her name is plainly expected from the seed list and the color list; Caurī is read. The deity's eyes are written sbyin, read as spyan, "eyes." In the first exhortation song the Tibetan has lha mo, "goddess," where the address is to the Lord; it is rendered "O lord." The speaker sbos mo is taken as Pukkasī. The color of Vetālī, "the color of the chief lady," is translated literally; its intended hue is uncertain.
• The lines on the five Tathāgatas conferring empowerment are taken with the Tathāgatas as the agents, as the instrumental marks them. "Compassion and the others" who offer praise are

presumably the goddesses of the maṇḍala; the text does not specify further. "The glorious Heru" stands as written, a shortened form of Heruka in the verse.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.